

Facilitator Self-Care Guide

Unburied Tools — Peer Support Operations Toolkit

You cannot pour from an empty cup.

Signs of compassion fatigue

- Irritability — small things feel big
- Numbness — you stop feeling moved by stories
- Avoidance — you dread sessions
- Intrusive thoughts — carrying stories home
- Physical symptoms — headaches, fatigue
- Cynicism — "nothing ever changes"

Boundaries with participants

- Sessions start and end on time
- You are not available between sessions
- Share own experiences intentionally
- Refer out when professional help is needed

Daily practices

Before a session:

5 minutes of quiet. Review the plan. Check in with co-facilitator.

After a session:

Write notes within 24 hours. Do a transition ritual.

Weekly:

Review themes. One non-work activity. Connect with a peer.

When to step back

- You dread sessions for more than two weeks
- Your own mental health is declining
- A participant story is triggering your unprocessed experience
- Someone you trust is worried about you

Stepping back is not failure. It is the most responsible thing you can do.